

No Frames, Please!

To further illustrate why frames should not be used, let's do an exercise. Go to www.google.com and search for the text "your browser does not support frames". The results you get are sites that are still designed with frames. You will notice that all of them have the same text because that is the message they are programmed to give browsers that do not support frames. Unfortunately, the Google bots read only text, and are thus classified as such browsers!

You will also notice that there are over 37 lakh such pages on the Internet. This means over 37 lakh pages on the Net that are not classified properly by Google, merely because of their design style; that's 37 lakh pages that may or may not contain useful information. What a waste!

The same holds true when users try and send the URL of the current page to their friends or colleagues. When the other person clicks on the link, he or she sees your home page, which perhaps has nothing to do with the reason the first visitor recommended a page on your site. This causes confusion. Of course, in modern browsers, people could just right-click on the frame that they want to re-visit and select 'Copy Address', and then either bookmark or e-mail that, but this requires too much work, and chances are the majority of your visitors will not even know that such an option exists.

Despite the obvious disadvantages of frames, some sites still use them. You would do well to avoid them like the plague!

Misleading Or Useless Page Titles

This is the text that is supposed to describe the current page, or at least your site as a whole. This text appears between the '<title>' and '</title>' code tags in an HTML page. Sadly, most amateur designers fail to notice the importance of titles, and leave it as "Welcome to xyz.com".

Again, this is very wrong when you take into account the way search engines display results: almost all search engines make the